



## Floating solar homes

Here are some of the best floating solar homes in and around the world you can probably live in ever. <http://dgit.in/Homesol>



## iOS 9.3

Apple's iOS 9.3 introduced some really cool features for iPhones. Here's a list of some of the cool features to try <http://dgit.in/9point3>

Tomorrow's tech

**Computer generated music:** We now have Liquid Notes (<http://dgit.in/LiqNotes>) and Maestro Genesis (<http://dgit.in/Mae-Gene>) which the creators claim are tools which allow a music composer to go further than he or she has been before, and with more ease. These programs, simply put, receive a few inputs from the composer about a particular musical technique and goes on to produce virtual instrument sounds in a large number of variations, giving the composer an idea of how his work will sound without the grunt work behind it. Omusic, an album composed entirely by AI Melomics109, sounds a bit like overly dramatic elevator music but is undeniably an achievement in the arts and, if nothing else, could at least be the end of the Kenny Gs we are forced to endure while trying not to breathe in a closed compartment full of strangers. (Listen to Omusic here <http://dgit.in/CrMusic>)

**Painting:** You would be right in thinking that painting is a very far-fetched concept for a computer to excel it. It's subjective, can be bizarre, and ties in all the culture, art, and psychology one knows onto a canvas in what can be an abstract manner. This didn't stop these guys from trying to do something similar though. The manner in which this was done initially was that the artist comes up with a concept, and then the algorithm generates the visuals for these either beginning from nothing at all or from pre-existing material. Art creating program AARON though, aims to do a bit more. Its creator, Harold Cohen, wanted that dependence on the human to be minimised so that it can be called an artist in its own right, sans the mood swings. He did this by teaching the robot about object and body elements and the relationship between them, instead of merely feeding it images. This means that the program can draw a table or, say, a cat, not because it knows exactly how it looks, but because it knows what the relationship between different elements in a cat and a table is like, resulting in some cool avant-garde art. Over four decades, the machine learned to place objects or people in a three-dimensional space, paint in colour on canvas using fabric dyes, and as its proficiency



And then he said, "My computer plays better than you"

grew, its paintings managed to even make its way into the homes of pipe-smoking, yacht-owning private collectors who paid more than 60,000 rupees and more for these machine generated paintings.

Out of the many art generation programs and machines that have been created though, the Painting Fool (<http://www.thepaintingfool.com/>) is one which stands out. Initially created to generate art from photos, the program increased in refinement, moving from the kind of filters and other elements one would expect to see in programs like Photoshop into a certain type of modelling where certain keywords that are first supplied by an external agent are then scrutinised by the AI form the image.

Years later, the creator gave The Painting Fool the gift of 'imagination' by giving it the ability to interpret ideas with lesser constraints, and without necessarily having to refer to a specific image.

This was realised when the software downloaded a news story on the Afghanistan war, picking up specific words to flick from Flickr. The program then rendered these images in an aesthetic, arty manner and made a collage out of them. The scenes contained a fighter plane, an explosion, a family, an Afghan girl, and a field of war graves, placed in such a manner which would have been regarded as drama for the eyes.

Remember when we mentioned that project AARON was the attempt to create an artist sans the mood swings? Well the creators of The Painting Fool thought that even that is an element which cannot be left out. They once setup the program to draw the portraits of visitors to a gallery, but it would refuse to draw if the last 10 articles it read on the Guardian website were downers. Because, well, machines have feelings too, if you tell them which ones to have.



No computer, I DON'T think I should leave it to you

**Writing:** Closest to our hearts and on par with games, technology, science, psychology, music, and all the good stuff, writing is another art which it would seem is inimitable. US-based Automated Insight's Wordsmith platform threatens to put the grunt journalist out of work by churning out reports on sports, profitability and business much faster and with much more reliability than ever before.